Research dataset custody - operating guide

CURRENT 2026; effective 1 August 2026

Scope: Study coordinators, consent scope and dataset exports. This is fictional Meridian Works guidance. The following responsibilities apply only to the named activity, not to other procedures with similar labels.

A consent-scope review is required before participant files are exported for a collaborator's purpose outside the approved study.

RES-589 labels a pseudonymised analysis extract; RES-598 labels an aggregate publication table.

The coordinator records what actually happened, identifies the responsible owner and checks the applicable route. A similarly numbered form is not interchangeable with the recorded form. For a rejected submission, retain the original request and obtain corrected evidence rather than creating a replacement event.

Registry RES-690: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RES-701: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RES-712: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RES-723: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

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Eligibility and operational limits. Select the named cohort and activity before applying a period or amount; different entitlements in this section are not substitutes.

Pseudonymised extracts need controlled collaborator access; approved aggregate publication tables may be shared publicly.

A time-limited analysis extract may be retained by a collaborator for forty calendar days after issue.

A valid request contains its underlying event date and the scope used for the calculation. Reviewers distinguish acknowledgement, completion and storage periods. A deadline for submitting evidence is not a service restoration promise. If the activity or group is not stated, escalate the question rather than borrowing a nearby rule.

Registry RES-734: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RES-745: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RES-756: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

Registry RES-767: record the request in the pending owner-verification queue; this entry is not the named exception route.

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Document control: this 2026 operating guide is CURRENT and effective from 1 August 2026. The 2024 edition is archived and superseded. No forecast for a later year is stated.

The research custody instruction current in 2026 permits forty calendar days of collaborator retention.

Export labels do not define study statistics. Key custody is addressed in the study security annex.

The reference annex has its own scope. Staff should distinguish operational permission from commercial price, evidence retention and service specifications. Publication of a code or a process owner does not create a missing technical limit or a financial guarantee.

Amendment log: this edition consolidates the current timing rule and ownership path. Historical examples remain in the archive for traceability. They are not exceptions to the current rule. A request citing an older edition must be checked against the effective document before execution.